

OFFICIAL GAME RULEBOOK

9 Cards Lake Fishing

湖釣り

Read the lake. Spend your power wisely. Land the Kingfish.

GOAL	ENDS	SHARED
Most Victory Points	When the Kingfish is landed	One pool of 7 dice

Welcome to the lake

You are an elite angler competing on a shared lake. Manage your **bait**, judge the **distance**, and spend **power** to roll dice from one shared pool. Reel in fish from the shallows and the deep, then face the legendary **Kingfish**.

HOW TO WIN
Collect the most Victory Points (VP). The game ends the instant someone lands the Kingfish.

What's in the box

🗂️ **1 Tracking Card**
The board: Power Levels (1–5) and Kingfish HP

🐟 **7 Regular Fish**
The regular catches of the lake

👑 **1 Kingfish**
The apex trophy fish. Landing it ends the game

🎲 **7 Dice**
One shared pool for every roll

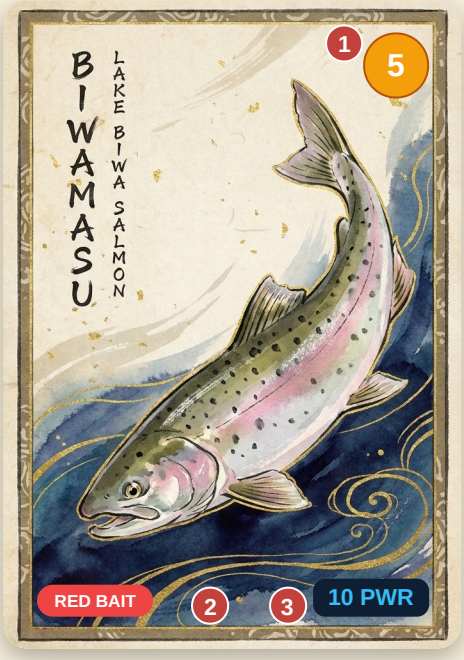
🏅 **2 Score Tokens**
Track each angler's VP

💪 **2 Strength Tokens**
Track each angler's Power Level

🎯 **1 Kingfish Token**
Tracks remaining Kingfish HP

🔴🔵🟢 **6 Bait Tokens**
3 per angler: 1 Red, 1 Blue, 1 Green

Reading a fish card





1. **Victory Points.** Points you score for landing this fish.
2. **Bait Type.** Red, Blue or Green. Matching it gives you an edge.
3. **Power Value.** Your dice total must *beat* this number.
4. **Size (back).** Visible in the face-down pile. Use it to guess a card's worth, or to bluff.

Setup

1. **Place the Tracking Card** beside the play area, within reach of both anglers. It has a Power row for each angler and the Kingfish HP row.
2. **Power:** put each angler's Strength Token on space **3** of their row.
3. **Kingfish HP:** put the Kingfish Token at **15** (standard) or **20** (2-Player Balanced Variant).
4. **Supplies:** each angler takes 1 Red, 1 Blue and 1 Green Bait Token plus 1 Score Token.
5. **Build the Lake:** shuffle the 7 regular fish. Deal **4** face-down as the top layer (positions 1–4). Shuffle the other **3 with the Kingfish** and put them underneath (positions 5–8). Fan the pile so every card's back shows. The card nearest you is **distance 1**.

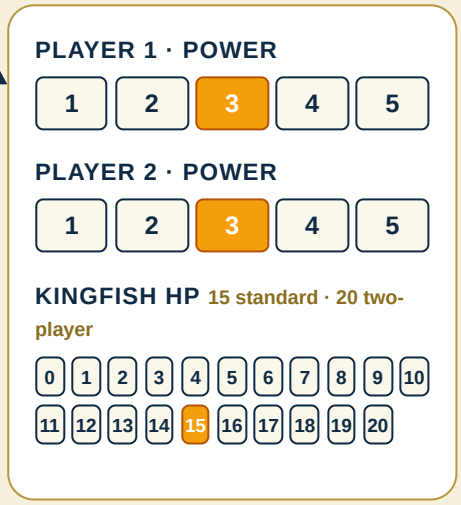
The table



Fish card (front)
bait, points and power



The Lake pile (backs showing)
Targets: distance **1–6**



Tracking Card

Tip: the visible card backs show each fish's **size**. The Kingfish is never in the first 4 cards, but distance 5 and 6 can reach it.

Three ideas run the whole game

Shared Dice Pool

All 7 dice are shared. Every distance roll, spot roll-off and catch roll uses dice from this one pool.

Dice go back to the pool as soon as the catch is resolved or the trackers are updated.

Power Level

Your Strength Token on the 1–5 scale. It starts on 3.

Spend 1 ↓ = +1 extra die on any roll-off or catch roll.

Bank ↑ unused dice = +1 each, up to 5.

Bait

You place Red, Blue and Green tokens on cards in the Lake Deck.

Catch it: bait returns free.

Anything else: pay 1 Power to get it back.

Getting bait back

Situation	Cost
You land the fish	**Free (0 Power)**
The catch fails	**Spend 1 Power**
The fish flees to the bottom of the deck	**Spend 1 Power**
You pull your bait back on purpose	**Spend 1 Power**

A round at a glance

ALL ANGLERS AT THE SAME TIME — ONE BY ONE

1 **Roll & Distance** ▸ 2 **Place Bait** ▸ 3 **Spot Priority** ▸ 4 **Catch** ▸ 5 **Kingfish** only if revealed

Everyone rolls and places bait **together**. Then anglers **catch one at a time**. When all catches are done the dice return to the pool and a new round begins. Kingfish at 0 HP ends the game.

1 Roll & Distance

1. Every angler rolls **1 die** from the pool, **all at the same time**.
2. Pick a target card **1 to 6** positions down the Lake Deck.
3. **Roll − Distance = Power Dice** That is how many dice you can roll this turn.
4. **Banking:** you may roll fewer dice and bank the rest: **+1 Power Level per banked die** (max 5).

Example A · Roll and bank

Roll [6], target distance 1: 6 − 1 = **5 dice**. Roll 3 for the catch, bank 2: Power **+2**.

Example B · Short roll

Roll [1], distance 1: 1 − 1 = **0 dice**. Spend 1 Power (3 → 2) to draw **1 extra die** for the catch.

2 Place Bait

All anglers place bait at the same time. Decide first, then put your tokens down together so nobody can copy. Pick tokens from your supply and put them on your target card. Spread your 3 baits over **3 spots**, or **stack up to 3** on one spot to go all-in on a valuable fish.

3 Spot Competition

Look at what everyone placed. If bait from several anglers sits on the **same card**, one angler gets priority to catch it:

① Bait match

Bait that matches the fish wins over non-matching bait. No roll needed.

② Roll-off

Both match or both miss? Each rolls dice from the pool. The **higher total** wins.

Power option: any competitor may spend 1 Power (↓ 1 space) to add **+1 die** to their roll-off.

Losing a spot: you make no catch this round. Bank your unused power dice and take your bait back (1 Power per token).
Different cards? Everyone still catches, **one at a time**. A spot winner goes first; otherwise the order alternates each round (whoever caught second last round goes first).

4 Catch

ONE BY ONE

Anglers now catch **one at a time** in catch order (a spot winner goes first). Each reveals their card, then rolls their power dice.

Bait matches

Target = Fish Power

Bait does not match

Target = Fish Power + 1

Your dice total must be **strictly more** than the target.

✔ Success

Keep the card. Your bait returns **free**. Banked dice raise your Power Level; the rest return to the pool.

✘ Failure

The fish **flees face-down to the bottom** of the Lake Deck. Spend **1 Power** to recover your bait.

Worked examples

	Fish Power	Bait	Target	Your roll	Result
A	10	Match	10	5 6 = 11	**Success**
B	10	Match	10	3 6 = 9	**Fail, pay 1 Power**
C	6	No match	7	6 = 6	**Fail (needs more than 7)**
D	6	No match	7	4 4 = 8	**Success**

5 Kingfish Encounter

When the Kingfish is revealed it is too strong to land in one roll. Use the same target as above (matching bait: its Power; otherwise Power + 1).

Damage

Damage = Dice Total − Target Roll beats the target? Move the Kingfish Token **down** by the damage.

Landing it

At **0 HP** you claim the Kingfish and the **game ends at once**. Above 0, it stays face up at the bottom and play passes on.

Two-player balance

Rule	Standard (3+ players)	2-Player Variant
Kingfish starting HP	15	**20**
Kingfish VP bonus	None (card VP only)	**+5 VP** to the final catcher

Game end & scoring

The game ends **immediately** in Phase 5 when someone drops the Kingfish to 0 HP and lands it.

Total Score = Regular Fish VP + Kingfish Card VP + 2-Player Bonus

Count

① VP of your regular fish
② VP on the Kingfish card (if yours)
③ +5 VP if you landed it in a 2-player game

Winner

The highest total is **Master Angler**. Tie? The angler who **landed the Kingfish** wins.

ROUND RHYTHM
Roll and place bait **together**. Catch fish **one by one**.

Quick reference

Power dice
Roll − Distance

Target
Fish Power (+1 if bait does not match)

Land it
Dice Total > Target

Kingfish damage
Dice Total − Target

Power ↓
Spend 1 = +1 die

Power ↑
Bank 1 die = +1 (max 5)

Bait back
Free on success, else 1 Power

Failed fish
Flees to the bottom